

Unit Student Learning Outcomes (SLOs)

- Define with examples the terms population, densely populated, population distribution.
- Provide reasons why people choose some places to live and not others.
- List the factors affecting population distribution.
- Show on a map of South Asia high density and low density populated areas.
- Provide reasons for increasing population in South Asia and explain how this affects the natural systems of the world.
- Provide examples of how countries in the South Asia are controlling population growth.
- Explain Population patterns in South Asia.
- Identify the growth of Population in Pakistan.
- Suggest reasons for why there are more men than women in Pakistan.
- Describe the problems caused by over-population.
- Suggest possible solutions to over-population.
- Describe the impact of various factors (eg. access to housing, food, water, education and healthcare) on the quality of life of the people in south Asia.

Introduction to the Unit

In this unit, you will learn what the term population means. You will be introduced to ideas about population distribution and the reasons why people choose certain places to live and not others. You will learn about the reasons why the population is increasing in South Asia and how this affects the natural systems of the world. You will also learn about the problems caused by over-population and the ways in which we can overcome population problems.

CHAPTER 1: POPULATION

SLOs

- Define with examples the terms Population, densely populated, population distribution.
- Provide reasons why people choose some places to live and not others.
- List the factors affecting population distribution.
- Show on a map of South Asia high density and low density populated areas.

Introduction

In this chapter, you will study the term population and distribution of the population also study about the reasons why people choose to live in particular areas.

What is Population ?

Population is the number of people living in an area such as a town or city or village. You would have heard people say that a place is too crowded or not so crowded. This refers to the population of a place. If a place is too crowded, we say it is over-populated, if there are fewer people living in comparison to the given area, we say the place is under populated. The following table shows the countries of the world that are most populated:

COUNTRY POPULATION (MILLIONS) in 2015		
Country	Population	Rank
China	1,346	_____
India	1,241	_____
United States	312	_____
Indonesia	238	_____
Brazil	197	_____
Pakistan	200	_____
Nigeria	162	_____
Bangladesh	151	_____
Russia	143	_____
Japan	128	_____

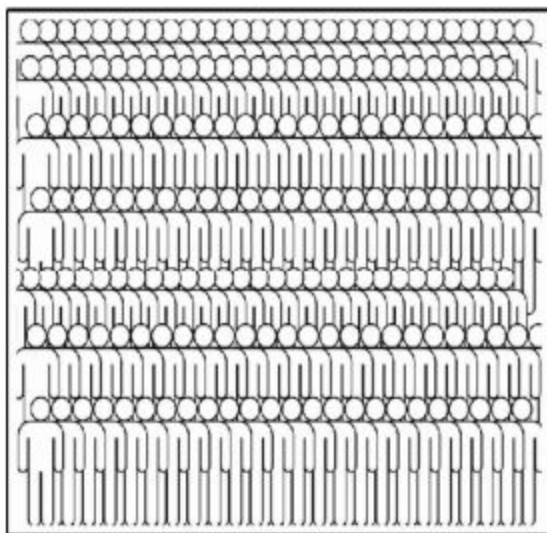
Activity:

- List the countries that are part of the South Asian region. Now rank them according to the country that has the most population.

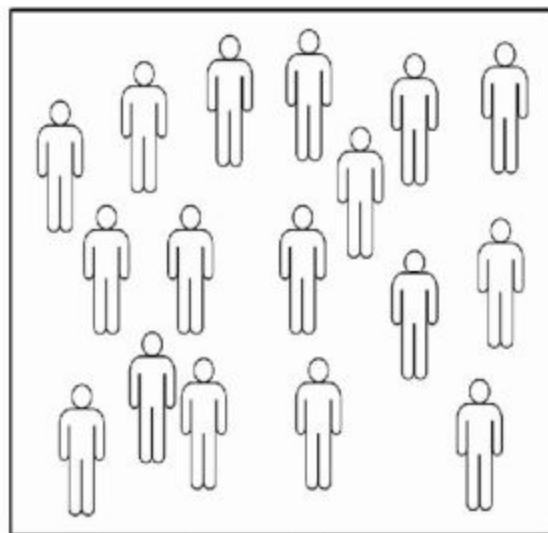
People live in large numbers in some places and in small numbers in other places. Depending on where people choose to live, we can have areas that are more populated and areas that are less populated.

When the number of people living in an area is more than the actual area available; we say the place is ***densely populated***. The more people there are in a given area, the denser the population. If an area has fewer people living than the area available, we call this ***sparsely populated***.

We can tell if a place is densely populated or sparsely populated through finding out about the population density. The term ***population density*** means the number of people living in one unit area of land and is expressed as persons per km.



Densely population per km



Sparsely population per km

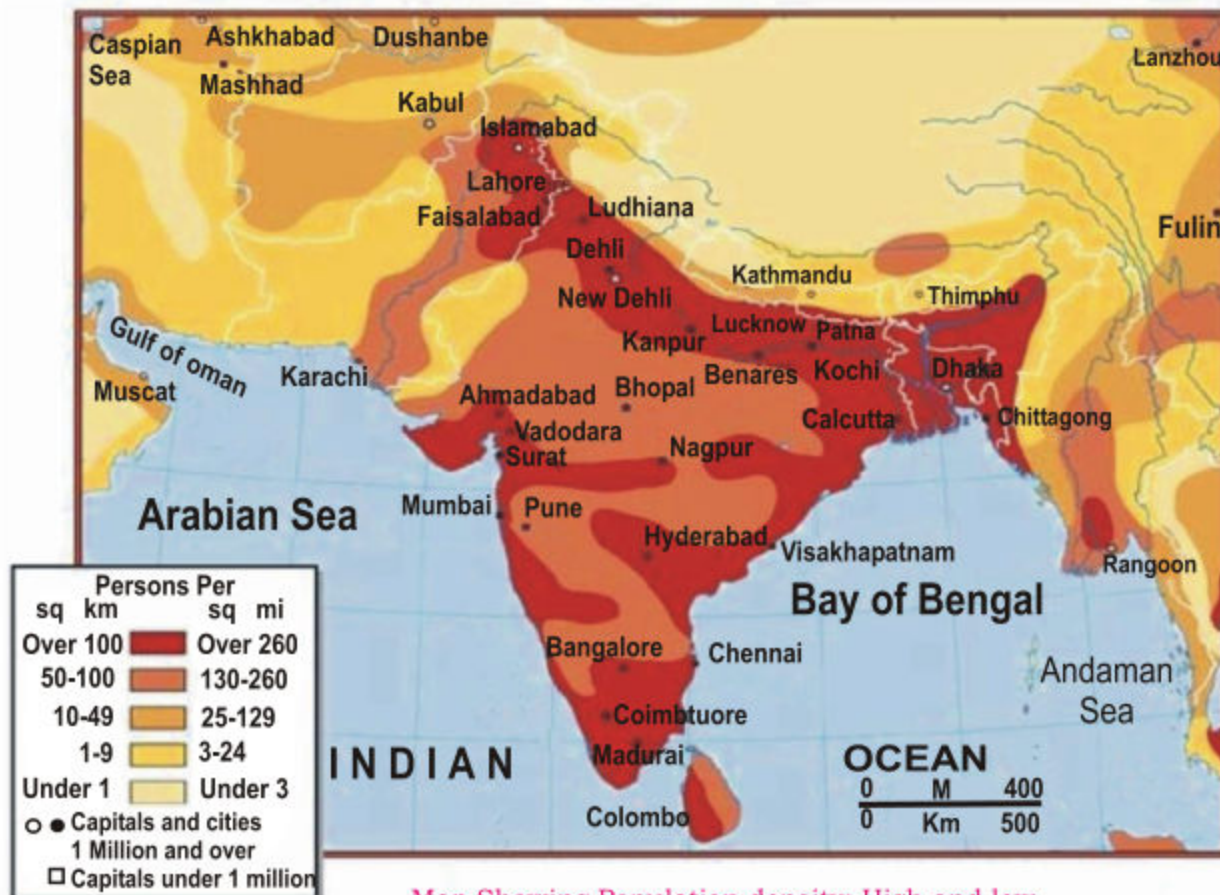
Population Distribution

The way people are spread over an area is called 'population distribution'. Population distribution tells us whether people are evenly or unevenly distributed or spread over a particular area.

Teacher's Note: Try this out in your class, draw a circle on the ground with chalk and have students stand inside the circle. Now, keep adding to the number of students in the circle. Ask students what they think will happen when more people are added to the same amount of space?

Activity:

- Look at figure below and identify the areas on the map of South Asia that show where very few people live or areas that have a low population density or sparse population. Now, identify the areas that show where many people live or areas have a dense population.

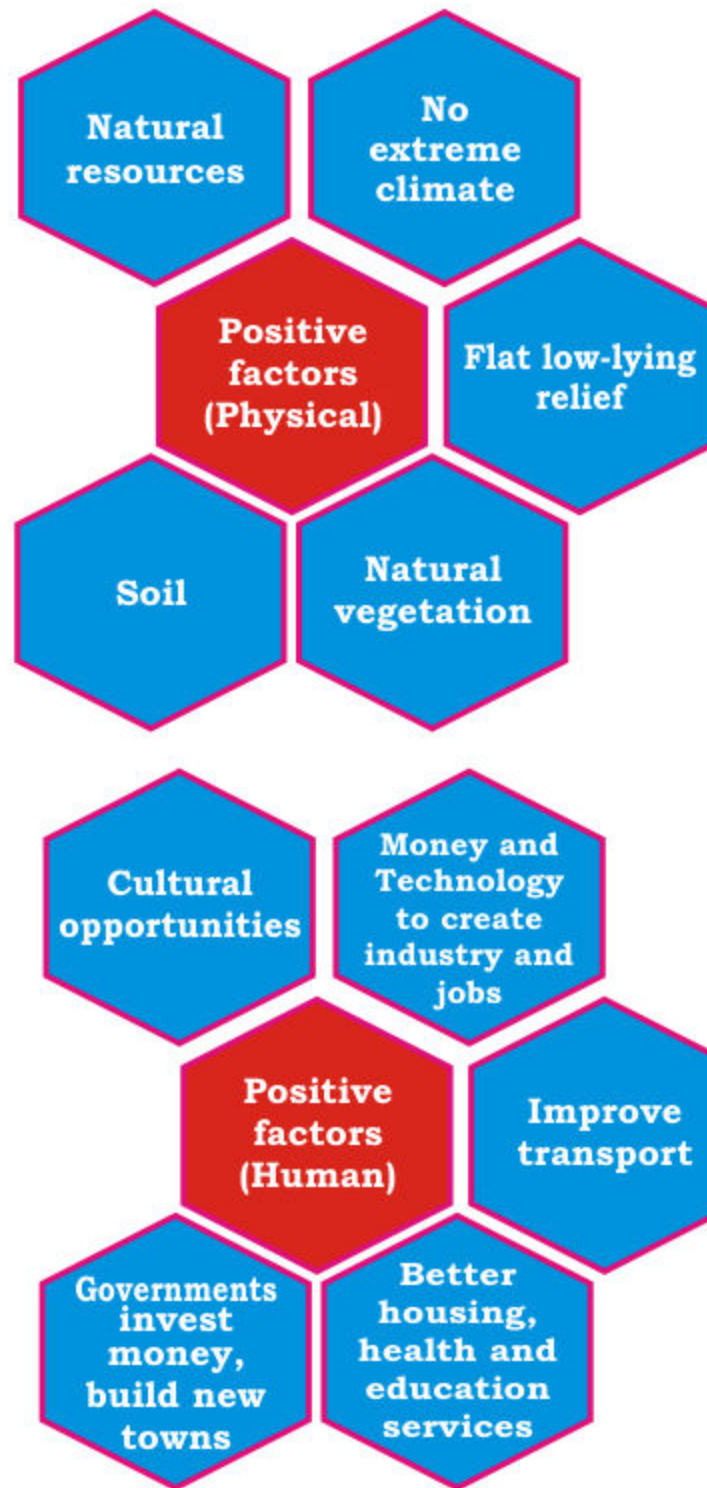


Reasons why People Choose to Live in Particular Areas?

People live in a particular area because of many different reasons. This could include reasons such as access to:

- Water
- Food
- Employment
- Transportation

Positive factors encourage people to live in certain areas while negative factors discourage people to live in certain areas. These factors can be divided into physical and human factors. Physical factors are to do with the natural part of the environment such as relief, climate, vegetation, soils and natural resources. Human factors are to do with people's activities which may be economic, political or social.



Activity:

- Make a similar diagram in your notebook and list the negative factors (Physical and Human) that may be responsible for why people decide not to live in a certain area.

Sometimes, political disputes cause people to leave a particular region or they are forced to migrate. Environmental reasons such as a drought can also cause people to move to areas that are better suited for their needs. Economic reasons such as job relocation or search for jobs and medical reasons such as a plague will cause a decrease in population.

In South Asia, a large number of people live where physical factors such as relief is suited for farming the land is flat with fertile soil and enough rainfall. In addition, people also live where they have opportunities of work, education and health care.

SUMMARY

The term 'population' means the number of people living in an area such as a town or city or village. Areas can be densely populated or sparsely populated depending on several factors that are linked to the natural environment such as relief, climate, vegetation, soils and natural resources and human factors that are linked to people's activities. People live in particular places depending on factors such as access to water, fertile land, employment opportunities etc.

END OF CHAPTER EXERCISE

A. Check Your Knowledge and Understanding

1. Answer the Questions Given Below

- i. What does the term population mean?
- ii. Give three reasons why people live in a particular area.
- iii. Explain the term population density.

2. Find Out More

1. Look through books/internet to find out what the current population of the world is at present.
2. Rank in descending order the ten countries with the largest population.

B. Use Your Inquiry/Investigation Skills

1. Find out what the population of your city/town/village was in thirty years ago and how many times has the population grown since.

C. Communicate With Others

1. Interview an elder and find out reasons for why people may have moved to/moved away from your local area.

D. Be Creative

1. Draw a pie graph showing how the population of Pakistan is distributed according to each province.

E. Cooperate With Others

1. Discuss in groups which country in your opinion will have the largest population by 2050? Give reasons for your answer.

CHAPTER 2: INCREASING POPULATION IN SOUTH ASIA

SLOs

- Provide reasons for increasing population in South Asia and explain how this affects the natural systems of the world.
- Provide examples of how countries in the South Asia are controlling population growth.
- Explain Population patterns in South Asia.
- Identify the growth of Population in Pakistan.
- Suggest reasons for why there are more men than women in Pakistan.

Introduction

There is a continued increase in the number of people or population in the world. In the last 400 years, the world population has grown 14 times faster than in the past. However, this growth in population is not 'even' or the same throughout the world.

A population grows because there are more births than deaths or more people are moving in than moving out. The fastest growth in population is in the world's poorest, less economically developed countries, in contrast to the richer, more economically developed countries. Can you think of reasons for this?

Reasons for Increasing Population in South Asia

There are many reasons for the increasing population in the world and South Asia. In most countries, the increase in population is mainly because the birth rate is higher than the death rate. The birth rate is the number of live births for every 1000 people in a year, while the death rate is the number of deaths for every 1000 people in a year. Simply, this means that more children are being born than the number of people dying. Discuss reasons why this would occur?

Activity:

- Look at the table given below and give reasons how the factors mentioned in the table are responsible for increasing population and reducing death rates.

Advances in technology	
Improved food supply	
Better hygiene	
Increased medical knowledge	

The drop in death rates has been the main cause for the rapid growth of the world population. People who study population – **demographers**, have noted that by 2050 the total population of the world may grow to nearly 10 billion.

The population of most developing countries is increasing rapidly. This is mainly because people in many of these countries tend to have more children. Other reasons for increasing population in South Asia are as follows:



Low literacy rate



Early marriage



Preference for sons



Social Security for old age



Poverty



Tribal conflicts and Family Power

Effect of Growing Populations on the Natural Systems of the World

An increasing population means more resources are needed to meet the needs of the population. Resources such as water and forest are renewable however, if they are used up more quickly than they are renewed, this will result in a shortage.

A growing population puts greater pressure on the natural systems of the world. There is an increased pressure on the environment for food production, access to water, housing and increased risk of famine and malnutrition.

It is, for this reason that the countries of the world try to control the growing population. Have you heard of China's famous one-child policy to control their growing population?

Activity:

- Conduct an inquiry on any South Asian country on how they are controlling their growing population.
- **Focus on your topic** (what questions do you have about population control, list them down).
- **Collect information** (look through a variety of text books, encyclopedias, internet, travel brochures, newspapers, magazines etc to get information about the measures put in place by the particular country you have identified for the inquiry).
- **Analyze the information** (decide what information answers your questions).
- **Draw conclusions** (organize the information in a logical manner. Decide how you want to present the information i.e in the form of a written report, a presentation, etc).

SUMMARY

Population grows because there are more births than deaths or more people are moving in than moving out of a certain place. Increasing population is of concern to most countries of the world as it has an effect on the physical environment and resources of the world. Countries have taken several measures such as educating their people, making policies to control population.

END OF CHAPTER EXERCISE

A. Check Your Knowledge and Understanding

1. Answer the Following Questions

- i. Give reasons for the increase in population in Pakistan.
- ii. Explain population patterns in South Asia.

2. Find Out More

1. Why have death rates reduced so dramatically around the world.

B. Use Your Inquiry/Investigation Skills

1. Find out about the growth of population in Pakistan since last 10 years.

C. Communicate With Others

1. Work in groups to suggest reasons for why there are more men than women in Pakistan.

D. Take an Action for Common Good

1. Write a letter to the editor of Daily Dawn and suggest steps to be taken by the Government for controlling rapidly growing population.

E. Be Creative

1. It has been said that educating girls is a way in which we can control population growth. Make a poster providing information about how to educate girls about the problem.

F. Cooperate With Others

1. In groups, work together to find out the cause about China's one-child policy

CHAPTER 3: GROWING POPULATION: PROBLEMS AND SOLUTIONS

SLOs

- Describe the problems caused by over-population.
- Suggest possible solutions to over-population.
- Describe the impact of various factors (e.g. access to housing, food, water, and education, healthcare) on the quality of life of the people in south Asia.

Introduction

In the last chapter, you studied that when a place has more people than it has resources available to maintain its people, we call it over-population. Over-population is defined as the number of people in an area that exceeds the capacity of the environment to support life at a decent standard of living.

Over-population is a result of the rapid growth of the world's population over the past one hundred years. Population increase results from a difference between the rate of birth and the rate of death.

Population in the world has increased because of several factors such as increases in food production and distribution, improvement in public health (water and sanitation), medical technology (vaccine and antibiotic). In the past, many children would die of diseases that are curable today. Discoveries and inventions throughout the world has lowered death rates and improved the quality of life for most people causing more people to live.

Over-population strains a country's resources and also gives rise to many other social and economic problems. One of the consequences easiest to see in our daily life is crowding.

Activity:

- In the previous chapter, you learned how to conduct an inquiry. In groups, conduct an inquiry on any one of the issues of over-population. Prepare a presentation on your inquiry.

The problems caused by over-population:



Shortage of living Space



Pressure on health Facilities



Unemployment



Water shortage

Possible Solutions to Control Population

Most people agree that population needs to be controlled. Countries have policies that aim to keep the population growth in check.

Some of the solutions that countries have adopted are as follows:

- i. Reducing birth rate, e.g. china.
- ii. Giving rewards for fewer children.
- iii. Imposing fines for more children.
- iv. Making birth control methods easily available.
- v. Encouraging later marriages.

Improving education and literacy and educating girls are other ways through which countries can control population.

Activity:

- In pairs, list other possible solutions that countries can adopt to control population.

SUMMARY

Over-population is the number of people in an area that exceeds the capacity of the environment. Over-population gives rise to many issues such hunger and homelessness. Educating people, especially girls, is one way in which governments can work to reduce population growth.

END OF CHAPTER EXERCISE

A. Check Your Knowledge and Understanding

1. Answer the Following Questions

- i. Define the term over-population.
- ii. Write two lines on each of the problems caused by over-population.

2. Find out more

1. Find out about the impact of various factors (e.g. access to housing, food, water, education, healthcare) on the quality of life of the people in south Asia.

B. Use Your Inquiry/Investigation Skills

1. Find out why do population shifts occur?

C. Communicate With Others

1. Work in groups to develop a plan suggesting possible solutions to governments to control population.

D. Take an Action for Common Good

1. Develop a flyer to increase public understanding of how rapid population growth limits chances for meeting basic needs.

E. Be Creative

1. Imagine that the number of students in your classroom has doubled. List the effects of this increase in number of students.

F. Cooperate With Others

1. Discuss in groups why sparsely populated regions are sparsely populated.

END OF THE UNIT EXERCISE

A. Check Your Knowledge and Understanding

1. Answer the Following Questions

- i. What is the difference between population distribution and population density?
- ii. Give three reasons why many families in:
 - a. Developing countries have more children.
 - b. Developed countries have fewer children.

2. Find out more

1. Why do people in South Asian countries like India, Pakistan and Bangladesh tend to have more children?

B. Use Your Inquiry/Investigation Skills

1. Find out the reasons for the uneven distribution of population in the world.

C. Communicate With Others

1. In groups, make a graph of the population of each classroom in your school. Find out the population of each class in the school and graph the populations on a bar graph.

D. Be Creative

1. Represent visually the factors that affect population density:

Raw materials for industry		
	What factors affect population density?	Poor infertile soil
	Job opportunities	

E. Cooperate With Others

1. Work in groups to complete the following task: On the map provided below; shade the areas that are densely and sparsely populated. Use 'red' for densely populated and 'yellow' for low population densities.

Map of South Asia- Population Density



Source: www.google.com